

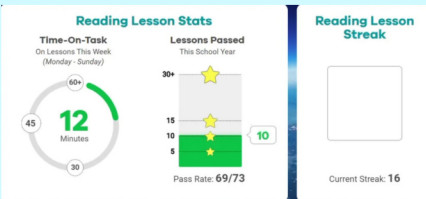
News Weekly

Lawsuit claims popular i-Ready learning app violates student privacy

A popular digital learning program, i-Ready, used in U.S. classrooms, is embroiled in a legal battle over student privacy. It offers reading and math instruction while tracking student progress. A California mother has filed a lawsuit against its parent company, Curriculum Associates, alleging data collection and sharing.

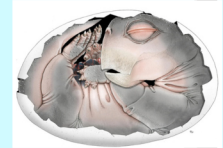
Nicki Petrossi, an online safety advocate and the parent behind the lawsuit, said she was unaware of the extent of data being gathered. "We didn't know what they were doing with that data. Who are they sharing it with? Who are they selling it to?" Petrossi said.

The lawsuit claims i-Ready collects over 80 categories of student data, including personal identifiers and behavioral information. Petrossi stated this includes names, birthdates, gender, contact details, race, IP addresses, and psychological data. "We are alleging that Curriculum Associates data practices violate our kids' fundamental right to privacy and the parents' right to protect our children from exploitation," she told FOX 13. (Fox News)



A 250-million-year-old fossil egg just revealed how an ancient survivor beat Earth's deadliest extinction

A recent fossil discovery is shedding new light on the remarkable survival story of *Lystrosaurus*, a plant-eating ancestor of mammals that thrived in the aftermath of the End-Permian Mass Extinction approximately 252 million years ago. This catastrophic event wiped out a significant portion of Earth's life, yet *Lystrosaurus* not only managed to endure the harsh conditions that followed but also flourished when many other species could not. The breakthrough occurred when a dedicated international team, comprising esteemed researchers such as Professor Julien Benoit, Professor Jennifer Botha, and Dr. Vincent Fernandez, uncovered a soft-shelled egg containing a *Lystrosaurus* embryo. This significant find confirmed that early mammal ancestors laid eggs, resolving a longstanding evolutionary mystery. The discovery, which was detailed in the journal PLOS ONE, was made possible through the use of advanced synchrotron x-ray CT scanning. This sophisticated technology allowed researchers to examine the fossil in unprecedented detail, providing valuable insights into early mammal reproduction that had eluded scientists for decades and opening new avenues for understanding the evolutionary lineage of mammals.



Build-A-Bear recalls roughly 36,000 Heart-Warming Hugs Bears

Approximately 36,000 Heartwarming Hugs Bears from Build-A-Bear are being recalled due to a safety concern involving the zipper detaching from the bear's pouch. The U.S. Consumer Product Safety Commission has announced that this detached zipper presents a choking hazard. The recall number, 034464, can be found on the product label located on the bear's leg.

These bears feature a heart-shaped insert filled with ceramic beads, which can be utilized as either a heating pad or a cooling comfort. They are rated for children aged 3 and older, with a recommendation for adult supervision. The bears were sold between January and March 2026 for \$48. Customers are advised to cease use of the bear immediately and return it to a Build-A-Bear store or request a shipping label online for the return. To date, no injuries have been reported. For further information, please visit the Build-A-Bear website.



Rare two-colored lobster caught by fishermen off Cape Cod donated to aquarium

It might be a divided lobster, but it has united New Englanders in fascination.

SA Cape Cod seafood company has donated a rare two-colored lobster to a science center, sparing the critter from the kettle because of its remarkable coloration. The lobster found is the typical brown color on one side and bright orange on the other, and the two-toned pattern goes all the way from its head to its tail.

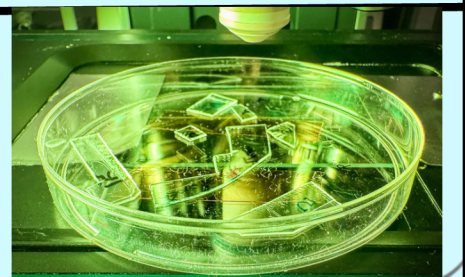
Representatives for Wellfleet Shellfish Co. in Eastham, Massachusetts, said Monday they have been fielding inquiries about the crustacean for days. The company gifted the lobster to Woods Hole Science Aquarium in Falmouth, Massachusetts, and it will be put on public display when the aquarium reopens, the company said.

"The lobster is now with Woods Hole Science Aquarium's animals currently being housed in holding tanks at the Marine Biological Laboratory during the aquarium's construction period. When the aquarium reopens, the lobster will be on display, offering visitors a rare look at one of the ocean's most striking natural anomalies," the shellfish company said in a statement.



Scientists create plastic that destroys viruses on contact

Scientists have developed a thin plastic film that destroys viruses the moment they land on its surface. This breakthrough could help reduce disease spread from frequently touched items like smartphones, keyboards, and hospital equipment. Unlike earlier antiviral surfaces made from metals or silicon, this new approach uses flexible plastic that can be produced at scale. The film, made from acrylic and covered with tiny structures called nanopillars, grips a virus and stretches its outer layer until it breaks apart. Instead of relying on chemical disinfectants, the surface uses mechanical force to disable the virus. Research published in Advanced Science found this method more effective than earlier designs that tried to puncture viruses. In experiments with the human parainfluenza virus 3 (hPIV-3), about 94% of virus particles were either torn apart or damaged so severely they could no longer cause infection within an hour. Study lead author Samson Mah from Australia's RMIT University said the team used low-cost materials that could be easily manufactured. "As nanofabrication tools improve, our results guide which nanopatterns work best to kill viruses," he said. "We could one day have surfaces like phone screens, keyboards, and hospital tables covered with this film, killing viruses on contact without harsh chemicals."



Riddle

What has one eye
but can't see?



Wordle for kids



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		11	16					12							6
		6		4		14					2			13	
	14			1				16				2	9		
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11	16	13			9	3	2	4		12	15				1
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Slow Cooker Honey Mustard Pulled Pork

Instructions

- Prepare the Slow Cooker: Place the sliced onions in an even layer at the bottom of the slow cooker.
 - Season the Pork: Season the pork shoulder generously on all sides with salt and black pepper. Place the pork on top of the onions in the slow cooker.
 - Mix the Sauce: In a medium bowl, whisk together the yellow mustard, Dijon mustard, honey, apple cider vinegar, brown sugar, Worcestershire sauce, garlic powder, and cayenne pepper until well combined.
 - Coat the Pork: Pour about half of the honey-mustard sauce over the pork. Cover and reserve the remaining sauce in the refrigerator for later.
 - Cook: Cover the slow cooker and cook on Low for 8 to 10 hours (or on High for 5 to 6 hours) until the pork is very tender and pulls apart easily with a fork.
 - Shred: Transfer the pork to a large cutting board or bowl. Remove and discard any large pieces of fat or bone. Use two forks to shred the meat into bite-sized pieces.
 - Final Toss: Skim any excess fat from the liquid remaining in the slow cooker. Return the shredded pork to the slow cooker (or a clean bowl) and toss with the reserved honey-mustard sauce and some of the cooking juices until well-coated.
 - Serve: Serve warm on buns, over rice, or in tacos.
- 1 tablespoon kosher salt
 - 2 teaspoons granulated garlic
 - 1 1/2 teaspoons onion powder
 - 1 1/2 teaspoons dry mustard
 - 1 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
 - 1 (3 1/2 pound) pork shoulder, trimmed and cut into 3 pieces
 - 2/3 cup honey
 - 1/2 cup Dijon mustard
 - 1/3 cup whole grain mustard
 - 2 tablespoons Worcestershire sauce
 - 1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar
 - 12 slider buns, or as needed
 - 3/4 cup pickled red onions, or as needed

